JFK, JFK

（肯尼迪，肯尼迪）

Revised Draft

October 21, 2026

Unless marked (in English), all dialogue is spoken in Mandarin and subtitled.

TLC: the NYC Taxi & Limousine Commission, which enforces against unlicensed cabs.

1 EXT. PARKING LOT EXIT - PRE-DAWN 1

The sky hasn't fully lightened. The exit is dim. Far off, beside a concrete pillar, sits a seven-seat minivan.

WANG QIANG enters frame from the distance. He's bundled in a bulky down jacket that makes him round as a ball. A crossbody bag hangs across his chest; his left hand holds a giant cup of tea, his right clutches two phones.

He approaches the minivan. It's filthy, caked with black mud spots and dust. He fishes the key from his jacket pocket, unlocks it, and slides the door open.

2 INT. MINIVAN - CONTINUOUS 2

It's freezing inside. A thin fog clings to the edges of the windows. On the dashboard in front of the passenger seat sits a solar-powered ornament: a little bobbing flower, perfectly still.

Wang drops into the driver's seat, tosses the bag onto the passenger seat, and clips both phones into the mount by the steering wheel. On the left phone he opens a walkie-talkie app.

DRIVER A (V.O.)
Kennedy, Kennedy. Kennedy, Kennedy.

A babble of drivers' voices pours from the app. (Content TBD from real recordings.)

He wedges the tea into the cup holder, puts the key in, and turns it. The engine coughs to life. He pulls out.

He turns the app's volume down.

He twists the AC dial to heat and presses the button. Nothing. He leans toward the vent. A foul smell hits him and he jerks back. A few more twists, a slap on the panel. Still nothing.

WANG QIANG
Fuck.

Wang rubs his hands and blows into his palms. He pulls the tea out of the cup holder and tucks it inside his jacket. Warmth spreads against his chest.

3 EXT. FLUSHING STREET - EARLY MORNING 3

The minivan drives through the streets of Flushing.

4 EXT. KTV PARKING LOT - EARLY MORNING 4

The minivan turns into a lot. Two other minivans already wait in line outside a karaoke bar. One is loading passengers, about to leave. Wang rolls down his window.

WANG QIANG
Morning.

DRIVER B
Morning.

Wang pulls up to the back of the line. Only one van left ahead of him.

CUT TO:

5 INT. MINIVAN - LATER 5

Wang opens a plastic bag: a steamed bun and an ear of corn. He eats while scrolling Douyin.

A chill creeps in. He fiddles with the AC again. Just then, another group comes out of the KTV: a STAFFER in a waiter's suit, a MIDDLE-AGED MAN, and a young couple.

Wang watches through the window. The middle-aged man sees the couple into the van ahead. As it pulls away, he keeps waving after it, eager to please. Wang inches forward and stops beside him. The staffer helps the man, too drunk to walk, into the van, then comes around to the driver's window

and hands Wang a cigarette. Wang takes it and tucks it behind his ear.

KTV STAFFER
Brother Qiang, look after this one for me today. I'll text you the address.

WANG QIANG
No problem. I'm off.

Wang drives away.

6 EXT. QUEENS STREET - EARLY MORNING 6

The minivan rolls through Queens, cheesy Chinese EDM thumping inside.

7 INT. MINIVAN - CONTINUOUS 7

Wang glances in the rearview mirror. The man in back is snoring. Wang turns the music down.

MIDDLE-AGED MAN
Don't stop... keep the music going!

Wang turns it back up and hums along.

8 EXT. RESIDENTIAL STREET - DAY 8

The music cuts out. The minivan is parked at the curb beside a house.

WANG QIANG
Boss, we're here.

Wang turns around to look at the sleeping man and pats him.

WANG QIANG
Boss, wake up!

Nothing. Wang sighs, pulls one phone off the mount, gets out, and walks around to the back.

As he steps out, he notices a police car parked not far behind. He immediately tones it down. He opens the rear door, snaps a photo of the man sleeping, pats his cheek, and frowns.

Back in the driver's seat, he makes a call.

WANG QIANG
Hello? It's me. The guy I just picked up fell asleep in the car. I can't wake him. He hasn't paid yet!

As he talks, he eyes the bag on the man's lap, then glances back at the police car, growing more agitated. We can't hear the other end. He takes the cigarette from behind his ear, lights it, and drags.

And so they sit, one awake, one asleep. Wang's eyelids grow heavy.

CUT TO:

9 INT. MINIVAN - LATER 9

Almost noon. Wang has his eyes closed, brow knit, arms folded, head against the window. The walkie-talkie app chimes. He half-opens his eyes and taps the phone.

DRIVER A (V.O.)
American Dream to Flushing.
American Dream to Flushing.

Wang locks the screen. In back, the man slowly sits up and rubs his eyes. Then his stomach heaves; a retch rises from his chest.

Wang hits the button for the rear door just in time for the man to throw up outside the van.

10 EXT. UNDER AN ELEVATED HIGHWAY - NOON 10

The minivan passes beneath the overpass, slipping through the cracks of the city.

11 INT. MINIVAN - CONTINUOUS 11

At a red light, Wang grabs a clear takeout box from the passenger seat and shovels in a big mouthful. His phone rings. He puts the box back and answers.

WANG QIANG
Hey, honey. I'm eating. I've been out since before dawn and only got one fare. Haven't even made back the gas money...
(pause)
What? Early dismissal? I'm not done for the day yet.

Wang yanks the wheel and swings into the U-turn lane on the left. The roar of a jet engine builds.

12 EXT. PLAYGROUND - NOON 12

A huge airliner sweeps low overhead, deafening. At the same moment, a toy plane enters from the foreground, glides past the slide and the swings, and lands on the rubber-mulch ground. We hear a kid making engine noises with his mouth.

KID
The plane has landed. Passengers, don't forget to pay —

GIRL
You've never even been on a plane.

On top of the slide, the KID (8, boy) and a GIRL crouch in a corner, playing with the toy plane.

In the distance, Wang, looking exhausted, hurries along the sidewalk. He reaches a WOMAN, says hello, and bows slightly in thanks.

WANG QIANG
Thank you, sorry for the trouble!

WOMAN
No trouble. They've been having fun.
(pause)
Hey! No fighting!

Over by the slide, the kid and the girl are squabbling over the plane. The kid loses; the girl snatches it away. He scrunches his brow and clenches the hem of his shirt, tears welling. Seeing this, the girl tosses the plane on the ground in disgust, giving it back.

Wang and the woman hurry to their kids. Wang scoops the kid up.

13 INT. MINIVAN - NOON 13

The kid sits in the passenger seat hugging his backpack, gnawing the half ear of corn Wang left from breakfast. Wang pinches his cheek.

WANG QIANG
Planes aren't like taxis. You need a ticket to ride one. One day I'll take you on one, and you'll see.

The kid keeps chewing and ignores him.

Wang sticks a menthol nasal inhaler up his nostril and takes a sharp sniff to wake himself up.

A driver's voice crackles over the walkie-talkie app.

DRIVER A (V.O.)
Kennedy, Kennedy. Kennedy, Kennedy, going to Manhattan.

Wang practically lunges for the talk button.

WANG QIANG
I can do Kennedy. I can do Kennedy.

The kid puts the corn cob back in the bag and notices the solar flower on the dashboard, still motionless. He nudges it. The plastic flower just droops, lifeless.

14 INT./EXT. MINIVAN / HIGHWAY / GAS STATION - CONTINUOUS 14

Another plane passes overhead. The kid shields his eyes from the sun and looks out the window.

Wang checks the time on his other phone, finds the airport passenger's number in the drivers' group chat, and calls.

WANG QIANG
Hello? I'm your driver. Got your luggage yet?

CHAO (V.O.)
Just landed. Still in line at customs.

WANG QIANG
Okay, call me when you have your bags. What's your full name?

CHAO (V.O.)
(pause)
I need to give my name for a ride?

Wang pulls into a gas station and parks. From the console between the seats he digs out a fistful of loose bills and scrapes together twenty-four dollars. The kid watches his father. Wang gestures for him to go pay inside for the gas.

WANG QIANG
Airport cops are strict. If anyone asks, say I'm your cousin. Don't say it's a ride. My name's Wang Qiang. Remember that. You've got cash on you, right?

The kid gets out. He hates the gas station smell. Pinching his nose, he jogs around the front of the van and into the convenience store.

15 INT. GAS STATION CONVENIENCE STORE - AFTERNOON 15

Through the store window, we see the kid count the bills one by one and hand them to the CASHIER.

Leaning on the counter, he spots a pocket flashlight in the display case. He looks at his father in the van, then back at the little flashlight.

KID
(in English)
Can I get this one?

CASHIER
(in English)
Sure. That's two bucks. Want me to take it out of your twenty-four for gas?

KID
(in English)
Yes!

16 EXT. AIRPORT ARRIVALS, UPPER LEVEL - AFTERNOON 16

A minivan cuts across from the pickup lane. At the curb, CHAO (21, male, Asian) guards five big suitcases, phone raised, scanning traffic. The van comes in fast and stops dead in front of him. Wang jumps out without a word, pops the trunk, and grabs the first suitcase. Before Chao can react, Wang has the second.

The third row is folded down. The suitcases go in like Tetris; Wang practically kicks the last one into place. He glances back at the curb. Far off, an OFFICER in a reflective vest is looking their way. In the passenger seat, the kid watches it all, not knowing how to help his dad.

The kid watches Wang slam the trunk, duck back into the driver's seat, and hit the button for the automatic door. Chao climbs in and exchanges a look with the kid.

WANG QIANG
Hurry up, kid. TLC's coming.

CHAO
TLC?

Before he finishes, someone raps on the passenger window. The OFFICER (male, 35, white, reflective uniform, sunglasses) signals them to roll it down.

OFFICER
(in English)
TLC. Hands off the steering wheel.

The officer scans the van and sees Chao and the kid. Wang gestures wildly.

WANG QIANG
(in broken English)
Family, my family. This my son.

OFFICER
(in English)
You're suspected of operating an unlicensed taxi.

CHAO
(in English; beat)
He's my cousin.

WANG QIANG
(in English)
Cousin... brother!

OFFICER
(in English)
Both of you, show me your IDs.

They fumble their IDs over. The officer points at Wang.

OFFICER
(in English)
What's his name?

WANG QIANG
(in English)
Yang Chao — I mean, Chao Yang.

OFFICER
(in English; to Chao)
What about his?

A thousand names flash through Chao's head, but not the one Wang told him on the phone. He freezes. The air goes still.

OFFICER
(in English)
Alright. Chao, right? Get your luggage out of the car. You can't ride with him.

Chao hesitates, then hurries out and starts unloading.

The officer walks to the front and writes down the plate. Wang scrambles out to argue.

Through the window, the kid watches his father argue with the officer and sinks into his seat. He looks back. Chao has unloaded everything and shut the trunk. A CHINESE-AMERICAN OFFICER (male, 40s) walks up from behind and joins the argument.

The white officer signs two tickets, hands them to Wang, and leaves. The Chinese-American officer waits until he's gone, then urges Wang back into the van.

CHINESE-AMERICAN OFFICER
Don't blame us, brother. Find a way to get a legit TLC license.

WANG QIANG
TLC licenses are impossible to get these days.

The officer looks just as helpless. He pulls a business card from his pocket and glances around to make sure no other cops are nearby.

CHINESE-AMERICAN OFFICER
For the tickets, go see this lawyer. Now get going.

He notices the kid in the passenger seat and gives him a little wave.

KID
Dad, I'm a little cold.

Tickets in one hand, Wang jabs the AC button with the other. Nothing. He slams the steering wheel a few times.

17 INT. MINIVAN / AUTO SHOP CAR WASH - DAY 17

Outside, the car wash roars louder and louder. Foam piles up on the windows layer by layer, blotting out the lights. The van grows darker and darker.

Click. A beam of light flares on the passenger side. The kid has switched on the flashlight and aimed it at the flower's solar panel. The little flower begins to sway gently from side to side.

18 INT. AUTO SHOP - AFTERNOON 18

A MECHANIC (male, 30s) is buried halfway under the hood, reaching deep inside as if searching for something. Another mechanic walks over to Wang and the kid, holding a tattered piece of engine insulation.

MECHANIC
Your AC wire's been chewed through. New York rats get cold at night and nest in your engine. Happens a lot.

Wang takes the insulation and examines it. It's torn down the middle, edges covered in bite marks. He sniffs it and whips his face away.

MECHANIC
This insulation has to be replaced. I'll add it to the bill. Fixing the AC wire will take at least an hour.

A rat in the engine? The kid perks up. He runs to the front of the van, lies down, pulls the flashlight from his pocket, and shines it inside.

19 EXT. FLUSHING STREET - AFTERNOON 19

Father and son walk down the sidewalk hand in hand. Wang holds the business card. They turn a corner; he looks up at

a sign: "AH XIA LAW OFFICE." They push the door open and head upstairs.

20 INT. LAW OFFICE ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS 20

Wang and the kid reach the office door. A man about Wang's age comes out holding some papers. Wang goes in.

21 INT. LAW OFFICE - CONTINUOUS 21

A cramped office piled with manila folders. A bilingual Chinese-English price list is taped to the wall.

SISTER XIA (female, early 50s, Asian) sits behind the desk, just hanging up the phone.

SISTER XIA
Sit. What's the problem?

Wang sits; the kid stands beside him. Wang pulls out two crumpled tickets and slides them across.

WANG QIANG
Got stopped by the TLC at Kennedy today.

Sister Xia puts on her glasses, looks them over, and sighs.

SISTER XIA
This won't be easy. Two of them.
(looks up)
The car isn't yours, is it?

WANG QIANG
It's rented. I pay by the month.

SISTER XIA
Let me translate for you: two thousand for you, two thousand for the car owner.

Wang freezes. The kid looks at him.

WANG QIANG
Wait outside.

The kid steps out. The door chime rings.

SISTER XIA
Two hundred fifty. Our lawyer goes to court for you and tries to get them dismissed. If not, we get them down to five hundred. No guarantees.

WANG QIANG
How does that work?

SISTER XIA
We pick the court date carefully. If we get a judge we know, we play the sympathy card.
(pulls out a form)
If you want to do it, give me your information.

Wang has already produced a plastic document folder, everything inside neatly arranged.

22 INT. LAW OFFICE ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS 22

The kid stands outside the glass door. Through the faded red lettering, he watches his father, hunched over, hand over documents one by one, talking with Sister Xia. We can't hear a thing.

23 EXT. FLUSHING STREET - SUNSET 23

Wang and the kid come out of the stairwell. Wang walks on, but the kid stays rooted to the spot. Wang turns and waves him over.

WANG QIANG
Acting up again?

Wang goes back, picks him up, sets him on his shoulders, and keeps walking.

WANG QIANG
Don't tell Mom about today, okay?

Wang walks down the street with the kid on his shoulders. A plane roars across the sky in the distance. The kid looks up at it. Ahead, the sunlight is glaring.

The sun is so bright Wang can barely keep his eyes open. The kid holds out his palm and shields his father's eyes.

24 EXT. MONTAGE - DUSK 24

- People cross at a crosswalk

- A train crosses a steel bridge

- Outside a market, people carry bags big and small

- An amusement park at dusk

THE END